Conversation track 15, 17, 18

Hong just got back from a trip to Lisbon. Her friend George wants to hear all about it.

George: Hey, welcome back! So, how was Lisbon? Tell me everything.

Hong: Amazing, mostly. But on the first night, I got locked out of the flat.

George: Oh no! How on earth did that happen?

Hong: I **was taking** the rubbish out when the door **slammed** shut behind me.

George: Let me guess. **You'd left** your keys inside?

Hong: Keys, phone, everything. And **I'd already changed** into my pyjamas!

George: That's hilarious. Sorry! So how did you get back in?

Hong: Luckily, a neighbour **was walking** her dog, so I borrowed her phone and called the owner.

Study Notes

How on earth did that happen?
Làm sao mà lại thế được?
"on earth" đặt sau từ để hỏi (how, what, why) để nhấn mạnh sự ngạc nhiên.
Cách nói tương đương: How did that even happen?

I got locked out of the flat.
Mình bị kẹt ở ngoài, không vào lại căn hộ được.
"get locked out (of)" là bị khoá cửa ở ngoài, không vào được. "flat" là cách nói của người Anh (Mỹ: apartment).
Cách nói tương đương: I couldn't get back into the apartment.

Speak Like a Native track 16

1. I was taking the rubbish out when the door slammed shut behind me.

weak: "was", "the"
linking: "rubbish‿out"
strong: "rubbish", "slammed shut"

Ngắt hai cụm: "I was taking the rubbish out" / "when the door slammed shut behind me". "was" đọc nhẹ /wəz/. "rubbish out" nối thành "rơ-bi-shao".

2. And I'd already changed into my pyjamas!

linking: "I'd‿already"
strong: "pyjamas"

"I'd" ở đây là "I had"; "I'd already" nối thành "ai-đol-re-đi". "pyjamas" (Mỹ: pajamas) /pəˈdʒɑːməz/ "pơ-ja-mơz": nhấn, kéo dài âm giữa để gây cười.

3. So how did you get back in?

change: "did‿you" (d + y → j)
linking: "back‿in"
strong: "in"

"did you" biến âm thành "đi-jơ"; "back in" nối thành "bé-kin". Tiểu từ "in" của "get back in" được nhấn ở cuối câu.

• Khi kể chuyện, ngắt câu dài theo ý: bối cảnh (I was taking…) / sự việc chen ngang (when the door…).
• Nhấn và kéo dài chi tiết bất ngờ (slammed shut, pyjamas) để câu chuyện hấp dẫn hơn.
• Giọng Anh (Hong) không đọc /r/ cuối âm tiết: door → "đo"; giọng Mỹ (George) đọc "đor".

Grammar Focus

Quá khứ tiếp diễn + when + quá khứ đơn

Quá khứ tiếp diễn tả bối cảnh, việc đang diễn ra; quá khứ đơn tả sự việc chen ngang. Dùng while trước việc đang diễn ra.

I was cooking when the lights **went** out.
While we were hiking, it **started** to snow.

Quá khứ hoàn thành: had + V3

Diễn tả việc đã xảy ra trước một việc khác trong quá khứ. Hay đi với already, just, by the time.

The train **had already left** when we **arrived**.
I'd forgotten my passport, so I **missed** the flight.
By the time he called, **I'd gone** to bed.

Role Play track 20

A: Hey, welcome back! So, how was Lisbon? Tell me everything.

B: Amazing, mostly. But on the first night, I got locked out of the flat.

A: Oh no! How on earth did that happen?

B: I was taking _____ when the door slammed shut behind me.

A: Let me guess. You'd left your keys inside?

B: Keys, phone, everything. And I'd already _____!

A: That's hilarious. Sorry! So how did you get back in?

B: Luckily, a neighbour was _____, so I borrowed her phone and called the owner.

Substitution Drill track 21

1. I was taking **the rubbish out** when the door slammed shut behind me.
   a. a photo of the view
   b. the washing in
   c. a call outside

2. And I'd already **changed into my pyjamas**!
   a. taken my contacts out
   b. washed my hair
   c. had two glasses of wine

3. Luckily, a neighbour was **walking her dog**, so I borrowed her phone and called the owner.
   a. coming home
   b. putting her bins out
   c. sitting outside